

Question no. 01:

Define Culture and Civilization. According to Maududi, what are the five elements of civilization? How do they apply to Islamic Civilization?

Answer:

Civilization (from Latin civilis) is a social system that helps man increase his cultural production. According to Maududi, any civilization is built on five core elements: its concept of worldly life, the aim of life, fundamental beliefs, the training of individuals, and the collective system covering law, politics, and social relations. Islamic Civilization fulfills all five: its worldview is grounded in Tawhid, its aim is worship of Allah and Khilafah, its beliefs come from Quran and Sunnah, its training is built on Iman and Akhlaq, and its collective system is the Shariah.

Islamic Response:

“I have left two matters with you. As long as you hold to them, you will not go the wrong way. They are the Book of Allah and the Sunna of His Prophet.”

میں نے تمہارے درمیان دو چیزیں چھوڑی ہیں۔ جب تک تم انہیں تھامے رہو گے گمراہ نہ ہو گے: اللہ کی کتاب اور اس کے نبی کی سنت۔
| (Muwatta Malik; 678)

“Islam is built upon five pillars: testifying that there is no god but Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing prayer, paying Zakat, making Hajj, and fasting in Ramadan.”

اسلام پانچ بنیادوں پر قائم ہے: اس بات کی گواہی کہ اللہ کے سوا کوئی معبود نہیں اور محمد ﷺ اللہ کے رسول ہیں، نماز قائم کرنا، زکوٰۃ دینا، حج کرنا اور رمضان کے روزے رکھنا۔

| (Sahih Al-Bukhari; 8)

Question no. 02:

Explain the Divine Origin of Islamic Civilization. What are the primary sources of Islamic doctrine?

Answer:

The foundation of Islamic Civilization is divine revelation, not human reason alone. Allah raised Prophets and revealed a complete code of life — Islam — to guide humanity in spiritual, social, and cultural matters. The two primary sources of Islamic doctrine are the Quran (the direct word of Allah) and the Sunnah (the sayings and practice of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ).

Islamic Response:

“Your guardian-Lord is Allah who created the heavens and the earth in six days... Is it not His to create and to govern? Blessed be Allah, the cherisher and sustainer of the worlds!”

بے شک تمہارا رب اللہ ہے جس نے آسمانوں اور زمین کو چھ دنوں میں پیدا کیا... خبردار! تخلیق اور حکم صرف اسی کا ہے، بابرکت ہے اللہ جو تمام جہانوں کا رب ہے۔

| (Al-A'raf; 7:54)

“He it is Who has raised a Messenger among the unlettered from among themselves, who recites to them His Revelations, purifies them and teaches them the Book and Wisdom.”

وہی ہے جس نے اُمیوں میں انہی میں سے ایک رسول بھیجا جو ان پر اس کی آیات پڑھتا ہے، انہیں پاک کرتا ہے اور انہیں کتاب اور حکمت کی تعلیم دیتا ہے۔

| (Al-Jumu'ah; 62:2)

Question no. 03:

Discuss the Universality of Islamic Civilization. How does Islam reject racial and national discrimination? Provide evidence.

Answer:

Islamic Civilization is committed to two principles: the Oneness of Allah and the Oneness of humanity. It is not tied to any geographic region, race, or era. Every human being descends from Adam and Eve. The only basis of honor in Islam is piety (taqwa), not race, color, or nationality.

Islamic Response:

“O mankind, We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into races and tribes, so that you may identify one another. Surely the noblest of you, in Allah's sight, is the one who is most pious of you.”

اے لوگو! ہم نے تمہیں ایک مرد اور ایک عورت سے پیدا کیا اور تمہیں قوموں اور قبیلوں میں تقسیم کیا تاکہ تم ایک دوسرے کو پہچان سکو۔ بے شک اللہ کے نزدیک تم میں سب سے زیادہ عزت والا وہ ہے جو سب سے زیادہ متقی ہے۔

| (Al-Hujurat; 49:13)

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ said in his Farewell Sermon:

نبی اکرم ﷺ نے خطبہ حجۃ الوداع میں فرمایا

“There is no superiority of an Arab over a non-Arab, or of a non-Arab over an Arab, and no superiority of a white person over a black person or of a black person over a white person, except on the basis of personal piety and righteousness.”

کسی عرب کو عجمی پر اور کسی عجمی کو عرب پر، کسی گورے کو کالے پر اور کسی کالے کو گورے پر کوئی فضیلت نہیں۔ مگر تقویٰ کی بنیاد پر۔

| (Musnad Ahmad; 22978)

Question no. 04:

What are the salient features of Islamic Civilization? Explain each feature with examples.

Answer:

Islamic Civilization has five key features: (1) Based on Islamic Faith — grounded in Tawhid and submission to Allah, exemplified by the mosque as a center of worship and learning. (2) Universal Dimension — not limited to one race or region, as seen in Baghdad, Cordoba, and Delhi thriving under Islam. (3) Moral Values — honesty, justice, hospitality, and equality are its core traits, exemplified by the justice of the Rightly Guided Caliphs. (4) Tolerance — proven by the Constitution of Madinah where Muslims and non-Muslims coexisted peacefully. (5) Integrated and Balanced — it insists on equilibrium between material and spiritual life.

Islamic Response:

“And seek the home of the Hereafter in that which Allah has given you, but do not forget your share of the world.”

اور جو اللہ نے تجھے دیا ہے اس میں آخرت کا گھر تلاش کر اور دنیا میں سے اپنا حصہ نہ بھول۔

| (Al-Qasas; 28:77)

“Allah commands justice, the doing of good, and giving to kith and kin, and He forbids all shameful deeds and injustice.”

بے شک اللہ عدل، احسان اور قرابت داروں کو دینے کا حکم دیتا ہے اور فحاشی، برائی اور سرکشی سے منع کرتا ہے۔

| (Al-Nahl; 16:90)

Question no. 05:

How does the concept of tolerance in Islamic Civilization manifest in the Constitution of Madinah?

Answer:

Tolerance towards people of different religions is the most important characteristic of Islamic Civilization. The Constitution of Madinah — the world's first written constitution — was built by the wisdom of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. Under it, Muslims, Jews, and other tribes formed one community (ummah). Each group enjoyed religious freedom, security of life and property, and shared responsibility for defense. It proved that pluralism and peaceful coexistence are core Islamic values, not exceptions.

Islamic Response:

“There is no compulsion in religion. The right way has become distinct from error.”

دین میں کوئی زبردستی نہیں — ہدایت گمراہی سے واضح طور پر الگ ہو چکی ہے۔

| (Al-Baqarah; 2:256)

Abu Dawud reported that the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ said:

ابو داؤد میں روایت ہے کہ نبی اکرم ﷺ نے فرمایا:

“Beware! Whoever oppresses a Mu'ahid (a non-Muslim citizen under Islamic rule), or diminishes his rights, or burdens him with more than he can bear, or takes anything from him without his consent — I will be his opponent on the Day of Judgment.”

خبردار! جس نے کسی معاہدہ (غیر مسلم شہری) پر ظلم کیا، یا اس کا حق کم کیا، یا اس کی طاقت سے زیادہ بوجھ ڈالا، یا بغیر اس کی رضامندی کے اس سے کچھ لیا — قیامت کے دن میں اس کا مخالف بنوں گا۔

| (Sunan Abi Dawud; 3052)